

Build a brand strategy that resonates

Start from the client's own words, not a template.
Six sections that every later design decision answers to.

VISION · AUDIENCE · IDENTITY · MESSAGE · GUIDELINES · MONITOR

BRAND STRATEGY DOCUMENT

Six sections, one direction

- 01 Vision & goals
- 02 Target audience
- 03 Brand identity
- 04 Brand message
- 05 Visual guidelines
- 06 Implement & monitor

STRATEGY BEFORE VISUALS

More than a set of visuals.

A brand strategy is a cohesive identity that communicates a brand's mission, values and personality — and it must align with the client's goals while resonating with the target audience.

✓ **Mission, vision, objectives**

Where the client is going and why.

✓ **Unique selling proposition**

What sets them apart in the market.

✓ **A defined audience**

Who the brand has to resonate with.

✓ **One consistent direction**

The same message and look on every platform.

WITHOUT A STRATEGY

“I like this template.”

A style with no client behind it.



WITH A STRATEGY

“The audience we defined chose this.”

A decision with a reason behind it.

CLIENT DISCOVERY CALL

Start from the conversation

The lesson's prompt is deliberately simple: paste the conversation you already had.

CLIENT

We are a small bakery. Most of our orders come from Instagram, and nobody remembers our name afterwards.

YOU

So the name is not landing yet. Who exactly are you trying to reach, and what should they remember?

CLIENT

Weekend orders for young families nearby. We want people to recognise the box before the label.

YOU

That gives me a clear audience, a clear problem to solve and a testable goal for the brand.

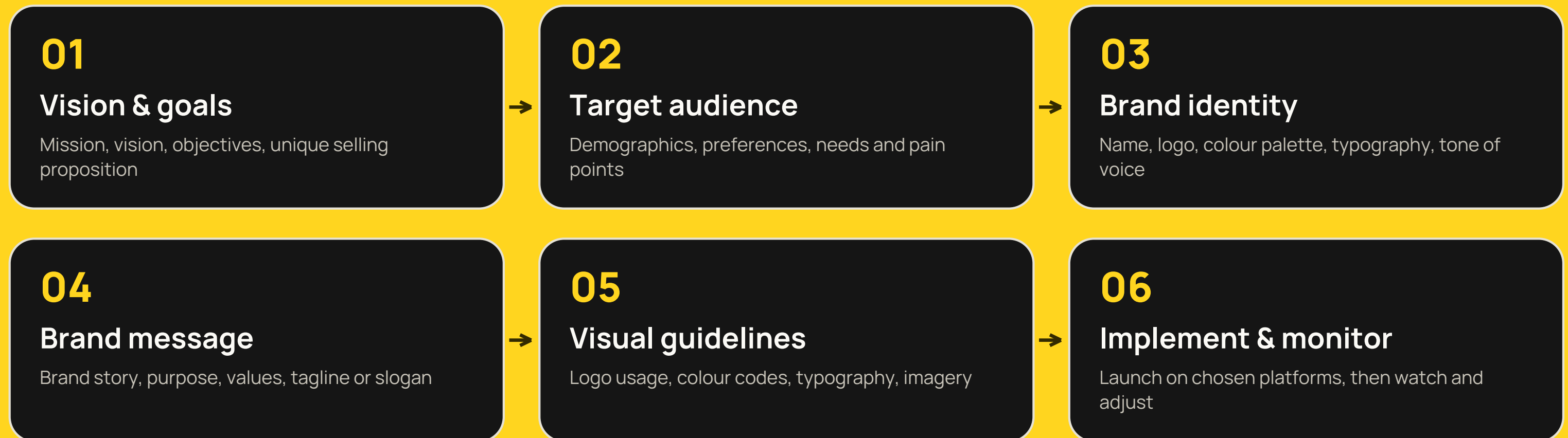
PROMPT USED

Using my conversation with the client, let's create our Brand Strategy Document.

SIX STEPS TO FOLLOW

Work through the document in order.

Each step feeds the next. Skipping ahead leaves you choosing with nothing to justify it.



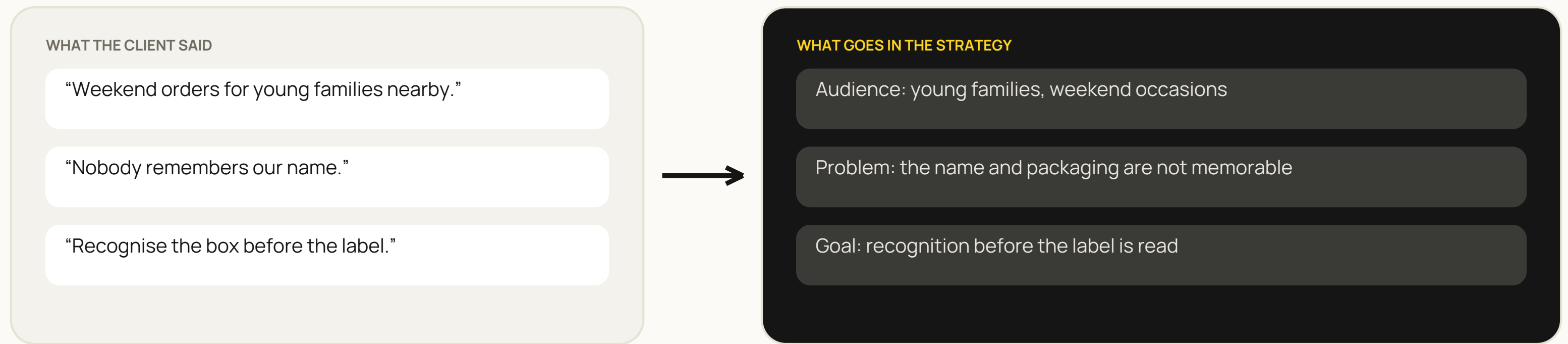
Steps 1 to 4 build the thinking. Steps 5 and 6 turn it into consistency you can measure.

FROM CONVERSATION TO DOCUMENT

Translate what they said

into what you write.

The call gives you raw material. The section is where it becomes something a designer, a client or a future teammate can act on.



Repeat this translation for all six sections. It is the difference between a strategy and a mood board.

STEP 3 & 4 · IDENTITY AND MESSAGE

What the brand is, and what it says.

BRAND IDENTITY

Brand name

The name the audience will repeat.

Logo

The visual cornerstone of the identity.

Colour palette

Defined so every channel matches.

Typography

One or two readable choices, used consistently.

Tone of voice

How the brand sounds in every message.

BRAND MESSAGE

The story

A compelling brand story that conveys the brand's purpose and values.

The tagline

Taglines or slogans that encapsulate the brand's essence.

Consistency across all platforms is what turns these five elements into brand recognition.

STEP 5 & 6 · GUIDELINES AND MONITORING

Write it down, then watch it work.

BRAND STYLE GUIDE**Logo usage**

Correct placement, clear space, minimum size

Colour codes

HEX values, not descriptions

Typography

Primary and secondary, with sizes

Imagery

What fits the brand, and what does not

IMPLEMENT AND MONITOR

1

Launch

Across the chosen platforms, aligned to the strategy.



2

Monitor

Watch audience engagement and the feedback that comes back.



3

Adjust

Make the necessary adjustments, then relaunch.

Style guidelines keep every marketing material consistent. The feedback loop keeps the strategy honest.

PRO TIPS

Three habits that protect the work.

01**Consistency is key**

Maintain uniformity in messaging and visuals across all channels.

02**Adaptability**

Be prepared to evolve the strategy based on market trends and feedback.

03**Collaboration**

Work closely with clients so the strategy aligns with their vision.

YOUR TURN

From client call to client-ready strategy.

Run all six steps and you have done far more than decorate: you have defined a brand and built a connection with the audience it was written for.